

Dhāraṇī of the Vimalā Uṣṇīṣa

Vimalā Uṣṇīṣa Dhāraṇī · Toh 602 · Derge Kangyur

བེམ་ལ་ཡུ་སྤྲི་ཤ་རྩི་གྲུ་སྤྲི་

The Dhāraṇī of the Vimalā Uṣṇīṣa, known in Sanskrit as the Vimalā Uṣṇīṣa Dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Bimalā Uṣṇīṣa'i gzungs, is a dhāraṇī text belonging to the broader category of incantation literature focused on the ritual construction and consecration of stūpas. It presents sacred mantras and accompanying ritual procedures for the planting of stūpas, explaining how even a single stūpa, when properly consecrated through the recitation of these dhāraṇīs over materials such as clay, can accrue merit equivalent to the construction of tens of millions of stūpas. The text belongs to the tradition of uṣṇīṣa dhāraṇīs, a family of texts concerned with the purifying and spiritually potent qualities associated with the crown protrusion of a buddha, and it promises that practitioners who engage correctly with its rites will ultimately attain full awakening. It is Toh 602 in the Kangyur, catalogued among the dhāraṇī and tantra-related works of that collection.

will be perfectly accomplished. And in the end, full awakening will be manifestly attained. The dhāraṇī of the Vimalā Uṣṇīṣa is complete.

The mantra for planting from one stūpa up to ten million stūpas, and the motivation throughout, are all the same. For planting one stūpa so that it counts as ten million, the mantra and the ritual procedure are as follows: one must recite this mantra twenty-one times over all the materials, including clay and so forth.

Nama trai ya dhvikānān. Jinānān. Bandhe ratnaṭāyan śubhana. Akṣobhya amitābhañca bande. Ahaṃ alokitaṃ. Namastry dhānugatānān. Sarva tathāgatānān. Sukṣme sukṣme. Nāga de. Śānte. Dānte. Śīva nirākule. Yaśo yaśo vati. Teje tejo vati. Sarva buddha adhiṣṭhite svāhā.

For the mantra used when pressing the seal or when writing the mantra, recited seven times:

Namas samanta buddhānān. Āpratiha ta. Śāsanānān. Oṃ vajra āyuṣe svāhā.

For the mantra for the ink-application:

Oṃ vajrod bhavāya svāhā.

For the mantra recited when placing ground powder inside the mold-vessel or inside the clay mold, or when anointing with oil:

Oṃ vajra araje viraje svāhā.

For the mantra for inserting the seal or the mantra:

Oṃ dharmadhātu garbhe svāhā.

For the mantra for inserting the inked impression into the mold-vessel:

Oṃ vajra dhātu garbhe svāhā.

For the mantra recited while striking with the mallet and pressing:

Oṃ vajra muṅgara akoṭaya hūṃ.

For the mantra for removing the piece from the mold-vessel:

Oṃ dharma rate svāhā.

For the mantra for placing the wheel and the finial crown:

Oṃ bhramatanye svāhā.

For the mantra for setting it in the center of the mold-vessel:

Oṃ su pratiṣṭha vajre svāhā.

When the ritual is performed in this way, the planting of one stūpa counts as the planting of as many stūpas as there are grains of sand —

Translator's Notes

- The passage is a ritual manual section, likely from a Tibetan translation of a Sanskrit dhāraṇī text associated with the Uṣṇīṣavijayā or a related Vimalā Uṣṇīṣa tradition. The mantras are transliterated Sanskrit rendered phonetically in Tibetan script; I have restored them to normalized Roman transliteration. Some syllables are slightly irregular as is common in Tibetan phonetic transmission of Sanskrit mantras, and a few sequences may represent corruptions of the Sanskrit originals, but the forms given follow the Tibetan closely.

The term རྩམ་པ་ལྷན་པ་ is a technical term for the mold or vessel used in tsa-tsa production; I have rendered it "mold-vessel" throughout for clarity. རྩམ་པ་ལྷན་པ་ refers to the ink or pigment used for stamping or writing.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those

texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.